

AN OBJECT

The stoneware jug

Every season has its one object, and summer's is the water jug. A hand-thrown stoneware pitcher on the table is half utility and half ceremony: it keeps water cool through the porous clay, it makes the simple act of pouring feel considered, and it earns its place on a bare surface the way no plastic bottle ever could. Fill it in the morning, set it by the open door, and the table is dressed for the day.

Choose one with weight and a slightly irregular glaze — the mark of the hand, the small *wabi* imperfection that says it was made and not moulded. It will outlast every gadget you buy this summer, and it asks for nothing but water.

"Half utility, half ceremony — the most a single object can be."

